

Vincent Van Faux

Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Ella knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
3. Persuade Claire that the student painting should not be displayed.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Round 1 / Motive

When questioned, read your answer. It is the same whether you are innocent or the murderer.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition.

Your next action

Ask the next seated guest their named Motive question in the question catalog. Note one grievance that might matter. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 2 / Opportunity

When questioned, read the answer for your role. Keep the section labels to yourself.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking him to withdraw the student painting. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the varnish sample stored inside.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:44, asking him to withdraw the student painting. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the varnish sample stored inside.

After answering, ask the next seated guest their named Opportunity question in the catalog. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 3 / Method

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: IF INNOCENT = Card A; IF MURDERER = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

When questioned, read your answer below, then your selected receipt. Leave the unused card hidden.

IF INNOCENT

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smear from my painting easel. That was what the materials desk issued me.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smear from my painting easel. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Put the read receipt on the Evidence Table. Discuss, then vote privately. The host will distribute FINALE envelopes only after collecting all ballots.